

Keeping clean

Having a daily hygiene routine, in addition to eating healthy and getting regular exercise, keeps a teen's body clean and free from smells. Additionally, good hygiene improves a teen's mental well-being and can boost confidence, too.

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Personal hygiene

Poor personal hygiene can be unhealthy, and can increase the risk of infection, so it's a good idea for teens to get into healthy habits as soon as possible.

▷ Unpleasant smells

Making good hygiene a habit during puberty can help teens to avoid potentially embarrassing situations.



Hair

During puberty, the overproduction of sebum (oil) at the root of hair follicles can make hair greasy and lank, or bind dead skin cells together, causing dandruff.

To avoid these afflictions, wash hair regularly with a small amount of shampoo and rinse thoroughly. Some people need to wash their hair every day, while others can go a week or more before they need to wash theirs.

Use the pads of the fingers to rub shampoo into the scalp. Avoid using the nails as this can break the skin.



Eyes

Washing the hands before touching the eyes reduces the risk of conjunctivitis, also known as "pink eye," as well as other infections. Visiting the optician regularly for a check-up is important, particularly if a teen wears contact lenses or glasses.



To help avoid spreading infections, such as conjunctivitis, never share eye make-up with friends.

Skin and nails

Skin is the body's largest organ so it's essential to keep it healthy. Exfoliating once a week, using a gentle scrub, will remove dead skin cells, but avoid doing this any more frequently as it could cause dryness and irritation. Moisturizing regularly keeps skin hydrated. Use a short-bristle brush to keep the nails and toenails clean.

Cleaning nails regularly using a nail brush gets rid of dead skin cells and reduces the risk of infection.

